

Parameter Class-Based Bounds — Design Spec

Version: v0.2 (draft for review) **Date:** 2026-08-05 **Status:** Design — review before implementation

1. Problem

The current `ParamTable` (FC) and `PARAM_LIMITS` (GCS) hold per-param (`min`, `max`) bounds that are tuned to individual airframes. There is no single set of per-param limits that suits all airframes:

- Headroom for the most demanding airframe makes sliders coarse for small-value frames.
- Limits end up hand-bumped per frame (e.g. the 12-tag edit in August 2026) and drift out of sync between `params.c` and `parameters.py`.

Additionally the FC currently **clamps nothing** — tag 17 (`ProcessParamsWrite`, `telem.c:1220-1248`) stores the incoming value verbatim, including out-of-range enums (`((uint8)u.f` truncates but does not range-check). A bogus value (corrupt `.af`, bad slider interaction, manual serial write) can enter the FC and reach the control loops in flight.

2. Objectives

1. **Safety:** the FC bounds every write (enums clamped to their range, floats clamped to a generous sanity ceiling).
2. **Per-airframe precision:** the tuning-slider range comes from the `.af` file, not from a global table.
3. **Class-based ceilings:** a small `ParamClass` table (**raw** units) sets the overarching FC hard bound for each gain/angle/rate family. One-off params (enums, distances, floored values, divergent-magnitude gains) keep explicit per-param bounds.
4. **Preserve legacy display:** the `ParamTable.scale` field is **essential and untouched**. It is GCS-only metadata: `display = raw / scale` for legacy units, `display = raw × DISPLAY_MULT` otherwise. The FC never reads it.
5. **Eliminate the sync ritual:** GCS `PARAM_LIMITS` is *derived* from the class table, not hand-mirrored.

3. Three-tier bounds model

Tier	Owner	Content	Role
1	FC <code>ParamTable</code>	per-param raw (<code>lo</code> , <code>hi</code>) — class-derived for gain/unit families, explicit for one-offs	Hard clamp on every write; generous by design
2	<code>.af</code> file [<code>LIMITS</code>]	per-airframe per-param raw (<code>lo</code> , <code>hi</code>) — optional	Precise tuning-slider range in GCS
3	GCS <code>PARAM_LIMITS</code>	derived from class table	Fallback slider range when <code>.af</code> has no [<code>LIMITS</code>]

3.1 Units and the role of `scale`

The FC works entirely in **raw** units — it never reads `ParamTable.scale` (verified: no `.scale` access at runtime in the FC). `scale` is consumed only by the GCS, and only to convert between raw and display values:

```
FC : ParamTable min/max = RAW bounds    (class-derived or explicit)
FC : clamp writes against the raw bounds
GCS : display = raw / scale              (legacy units, legacy checkbox)
      display = raw * DISPLAY_MULT       (everything else; DISPLAY_MULT 1/scale)
GCS : slider range = raw_bound * display_mult
```

The class table therefore lives in **raw** units — the FC needs no scale math. The GCS converts raw → display exactly as it does today; nothing about the display path changes.

4. FC ParamClass design

4.1 Class table (RAW-unit ceilings)

Class ceilings are deliberately **generous** — they exist to reject bogus values, not to encode tuned ranges. A class is only used where its members are of comparable magnitude; divergent members become one-offs (§4.3). Values below are **proposals** to be validated against every `.af` file during implementation (there is an existing tuner check that asserts tuned values ≤ limits). All bounds are **raw FC units**.

<code>classGainRateP</code>	0 - 3.0	(rate P gains; raw)
<code>classGainRateD</code>	0 - 0.2	(rate D gains; raw)
<code>classGainRateI</code>	0 - 0.2	(yaw rate I)
<code>classGainAngleQ</code>	0 - 20	(quaternion angle P)
<code>classGainAngleI</code>	0 - 25	(angle integral)
<code>classGainAlt</code>	0 - 3.66	(alt position/vel/ROC loop)
<code>classGainNav</code>	0 - 15	(nav position/vel/crosstrack)
<code>classGainCam</code>	0 - 20	(camera gimbal)
<code>classGainKf</code>	0 - 20	(KF variances)
<code>classRateIntLim</code>	0 - 30	(rad/s integral clamps)
<code>classAngle</code>	0 - 1.047	(rad - 60°)
<code>classAngleBipolar</code>	-0.349 - 0.349	(rad - ±20°)
<code>classRate</code>	0 - 10.472	(rad/s - 600°/s)
<code>classPct</code>	0 - 1.0	(fraction - 100%)
<code>classPctS</code>	0 - 0.5	(fraction/s - 50%/s)
<code>classHz</code>	0 - 255	(Hz)
<code>classVolts</code>	0 - 255	(V)
<code>classAmps</code>	0 - 255	(A)
<code>classMetres</code>	0 - 1000	(m - fallback only; see 5.2)
<code>classMs</code>	0 - 50	(m/s)
<code>classMah</code>	1500 - 10000	(mAh)
<code>classSeconds</code>	0 - 60	(s)

4.2 ParamMetaEntry change

Add a `uint8 cls` field (index into `ParamClassBounds[]`). The per-param raw min/max are **computed** from the class:

```
real32 lo = ParamClass[e->cls].lo;    // raw, no scale math
real32 hi = ParamClass[e->cls].hi;    // raw, no scale math
```

scale stays in the entry **unchanged** — it is GCS-only metadata and must never be folded into the bound.

4.3 One-offs (classExplicit)

For params that do not fit a shared class — enums, bitmasks, floored values, distances, times, divergent-magnitude gains — the entry carries **explicit** (lo, hi) in the macro call and cls = classExplicit (raw bound = the explicit pair). These are the majority of the table; the class table above covers only the gain/angle/rate families where sharing is meaningful.

4.4 Clamp every write

In ProcessParamsWrite (telem.c) and in PackParametersToConfig() (params.c:255), clamp before storing:

```
if (e->type == PARAM_FLOAT)
    u.f = fclamp(u.f, lo, hi);
else
    u.f = (real32) uclamp((uint8)u.f, (uint8)lo, (uint8)hi); // enum range clamp
```

This closes the current gap where out-of-range enums are stored verbatim.

5. GCS design

5.1 Derived PARAM_LIMITS

parameters.py gains the ParamClassBounds table (~25 rows, **raw** units — identical numbers to the FC). At import:

```
PARAM_LIMITS[idx] = (cls_lo, cls_hi) # raw - no scale multiply
```

PARAM_SCALES remains untouched (GCS-only, display conversion). The 128 literal tuples and the AGENTS.md mirror ritual are removed. A unit test recomputes PARAM_LIMITS from the table and asserts known raw values.

5.2 .af per-airframe [LIMITS]

Optional block; values in **raw FC units** (consistent with the rest of the .af file — .af stores FC-native values, see airframes.py _parse_value):

```
[LIMITS]
ROLL_RATE_KP = 0, 0.913
ROLL_ANGLE_Q_KP = 0, 11.2
ALT_POS_KP = 0.35, 1.83
```

- Slider range for a param = .af [LIMITS] entry if present, else tier-3 PARAM_LIMITS (raw → × display_mult for the spinbox).
- .af values outside the FC tier-1 ceiling are flagged (orange) but still blocked by the FC clamp at write time.
- Migration: every shipped .af gets a [LIMITS] block generated from its current values (bracket ×2, round). The tier-3 fallback exists only so a new/unknown frame is still editable.

6. 128-param → class mapping (provisional)

Legend: C = shared class (ceiling via section 4.1), X = explicit per-param (lo, hi), U = unused (kept as X (0,255)), R = read-only (BootDiag / reset cause — accepted, not clamped meaningfully).

Gains — attitude rate

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
0	RollRateKp	F	classGainRateP	0.005	0 – 3.0
5	PitchRateKp	F	classGainRateP	0.005	0 – 3.0
10	YawRateKp	F	classGainRateP	0.005	0 – 3.0
11	RollRateKd	F	classGainRateD	0.0001	0 – 0.2
27	PitchRateKd	F	classGainRateD	0.0001	0 – 0.2
90	YawRateKd	F	classGainRateD	0.000025	0 – 0.05
108	YawRateKi	F	classGainRateI	0.001	0 – 0.2
109	YawRateIntLim	F	X (0, 2.0)	0.01	0 – 2.0

Gains — attitude angle

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
2	RollAngleQKp	F	classGainAngleQ	1.0	0 – 20
7	PitchAngleQKp	F	classGainAngleQ	1.0	0 – 20
96	YawAngleQKp	F	classGainAngleQ	1.0	0 – 20
23	RollAngleQKi	F	classGainAngleI	0.05	0 – 25
24	PitchAngleQKi	F	classGainAngleI	0.05	0 – 25
97	YawAngleQKi	F	classGainAngleI	0.05	0 – 25
4	RollAngleQIntLimit	F	classRateIntLim	0.015	0 – 30
9	PitchAngleQIntLimit	F	classRateIntLim	0.015	0 – 30
98	YawAngleQIntLimit	F	classRateIntLim	0.000873	0 – 30

Altitude & nav gains

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
1	AltPosKi	F	classGainAlt	0.00046	0 – 3.66
6	AltPosKp	F	classGainAlt	0.0183	0 – 3.66
29	AltVelKd	F	classGainAlt	1.0	0 – 3.66
99	AltPosIntLimit	F	classGainAlt	0.05	0 – 3.66
101	AltVelKi	F	classGainAlt	0.00027	0 – 3.66
120	AltROCKp	F	classGainAlt	0.001	0 – 3.66
28	NavVelKp	F	classGainNav	0.06	0 – 15
40	NavPosIntLimit	F	classGainNav	1.0	0 – 15
48	NavCrossTrackKp	F	classGainNav	0.01	0 – 15
56	NavPosKp	F	classGainNav	0.0165	0 – 15
60	NavPosKi	F	classGainNav	0.004	0 – 15

Misc gains

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
18	RollCamKp	F	classGainCam	0.1	0 - 20
25	PitchCamKp	F	classGainCam	0.1	0 - 20
72	KFAccUBiasVar	F	classGainKf	1.0	0 - 20
110	KFBaroVar	F	classGainKf	1.0	0 - 20
111	KFAccUVar	F	classGainKf	1.0	0 - 20
31	MadgwickKpMag	F	X (0, 0.55)	0.01	0 - 0.55
38	MadgwickKpAcc	F	X (0, 0.5)	1.0	0 - 0.5
30	Horizon	F	X (0, 50)	1.0	0 - 50
52	AccConfSD	F	X (0, 50)	1.0	0 - 50

Angles & rates (deg / deg/s)

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
33	NavMagVar	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
67	FWMaxClimbAngle	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
68	NavMaxAngle	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
74	MaxPitchAngle	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
76	MaxRollAngle	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
78	NavHeadingTurnRate	F	classAngle	DEG_RAD	0 - 1.047
113	FWRollControlPitchLimit	F	X (0.785, 1.047)	DEG_RAD	45-60 deg
81	FWBoardPitchAngle	F	classAngleBipolar	DEG_RAD	-0.349 - 0.349
63	MaxYawRate	F	classRate	DEG_RAD	0 - 10.472
82	MaxRollRate	F	classRate	DEG_RAD	0 - 10.472
83	MaxPitchRate	F	classRate	DEG_RAD	0 - 10.472
88	MaxHeadingRate	F	classRate	DEG_RAD	0 - 10.472

Percent / fraction

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
19	EstCruiseThr	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
20	StickHysteresis	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
21	FWClimbThrottle	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
22	PercentIdleThr	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
39	RollCamTrim	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
58	Balance	F	X (-0.2, 0.5)	0.01	-0.2 - 0.5
64	FWRollPitchFF	F	classPct	1.0	0 - 1.0
65	FWPitchThrottleFF	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
70	FWAileronDifferential	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
80	YawSymmetryFactor	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
86	FWAileronRudderMix	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
87	FWAltSpoilerFF	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
102	AltThrottleCompLimit	F	X (0, 0.25)	0.01	0 - 0.25
112	FWStickScale	F	X (0.15, 1.0)	0.01	0.15 - 1.0
114	AHThrottleMovingWindow	F	classPct	0.01	0 - 1.0
119	BatteryAlarmPct	F	X (0.05, 0.5)	0.01	0.05 - 0.5
122	RudderMotorFF	F	X (0, 20)	0.01	0 - 20
69	FWSpoilerDecayPercentPS	F	classPctS	0.001	0 - 0.5

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
79	AltHoldThrCompDecayPercentPS	F	X (0, 0.2)	1.0	0 - 0.2

Scalar (Hz / V / A / m / m/s / mAh / s)

Tag	Param	Type	Class	Scale	Raw bound
26	ServoLPFHz	F	classHz	1.0	0 - 255
77	YawLPFHz	F	X (25, 255)	1.0	25 - 255
17	LowVoltThres	F	X (9, 20)	1.0	9 - 20
85	VoltScale	F	classVolts	1.0	0 - 255
84	CurrentScale	F	classAmps	1.0	0 - 255
32	NavRTHAlt	F	X (0, 30)	1.0	0 - 30
106	NavProxAltM	F	X (0, 10)	1.0	0 - 10
107	NavProxRadiusM	F	X (0, 30)	1.0	0 - 30
115	NavFenceRadiusM	F	X (0, 1000)	1.0	0 - 1000
116	DiveRecoverAlt	F	X (10, 200)	1.0	10 - 200
45	MaxDescentRateDmpS	F	X (0, 50)	1.0	0 - 50
103	VRSROC	F	X (-50, 0)	1.0	-50 - 0
105	AHROCWindowMPS	F	X (0, 30)	1.0	0 - 30
53	BatteryCapacity	F	classMah	1.0	1500 - 10000
46	DescentDelayS	U8	X (0, 30)	1	0 - 30
118	FailsafeDelay	U8	X (0, 60)	1	0 - 60

Enums / bitmasks (explicit = enum range)

Tag	Param	Type	Bound
3	ArmingMode	U8	0 - 1
8	RFSensorType	U8	0 - MaxSonarcm
12	IMUFiltType	U8	0 - IMU_FILT_TYPE_MAX
13	BBLogType	U8	0 - logYaw
14	RxType	U8	0 - UnknownRx
15	Config1Bits	U8	0 - CONFIG_BITS_MAX
35	ESCType	U8	0 - MotorsOff
36	RCChannels	U8	0 - 16
43	AFTType	U8	0 - AFUnknown
44	TelemetryType	U8	0 - u8Telemetry
47	GyroLPFSel	U8	0 - GYRO_LPF_SEL_MAX
51	ServoSense	U8	0 - 127
71	ASSensorType	U8	0 - noAS
73	Config2Bits	U8	0 - CONFIG_BITS_MAX
89	AccLPFSel	U8	0 - ACC_LPF_SEL_MAX
92	ThrottleGainRate	U8	0 - 100
100	MotorStopSel	U8	0 - landContactSw
117	FailsafeAction	U8	0 - 2

Channel maps (U8, 0 - 15)

16, 37, 41, 42, 49, 50, 54, 55, 59, 93, 94, 95 — Map[...] RC channel selectors. Explicit bound 0 - 15.

Read-only / diagnostics (accepted, clamped to 0-255)

104 BootDiag, 127 PowerResetCause — R.

Unused slots

34, 57, 61, 62, 66, 75, 91, 121, 123, 124, 125, 126 — U (0, 255).

7. Migration plan

1. **FC:** add `cls` field to `ParamMetaEntry`; add `ParamClassBounds[]`; re-map all 128 `FLOAT()/U8()` macro calls to class ids (section 6); implement the clamp in `ProcessParamsWrite + PackParametersToConfig`. → `ParamTableCRC` changes, layout identical → **cal preserved**, no magic bump.
2. **GCS:** add `ParamClassBounds` table; derive `PARAM_LIMITS`; add `.af [LIMITS]` parser + slider wiring; add unit test.
3. **Revert the 12-tag limit hacks** (Aug 2026) back to clean class ceilings; the per-frame precision moves into each `.af [LIMITS]` block.
4. **.af migration:** generate `[LIMITS]` blocks for all shipped frames (bracket current values $\times 2$), review, ship.
5. **Validate:** tuner asserts tuned values $\leq$ FC ceiling for all 17 frames; GCS `py_compile` + unit tests.

8. Bounds-tuning feedback loop

Class ceilings are a first guess, not gospel. Expect to tighten/loosen them as real tuned ranges are learned. The GCS readback verification already provides the signals — no new GCS plumbing needed:

- **Too tight:** `_verify_parameters` (`parameter_window.py`) reports `Written=X → Clamped to Y (max=Z)` on the bulk-readback check (tag 71) when the FC clamped a write to the ceiling. Widen the class (or promote the param to a one-off with a larger bound).
- **Too loose:** a param's tuned values across all frames cluster well below the ceiling — the class can be tightened for better fallback-slider resolution.

`[LIMITS]` blocks per airframe should be tracked so that tuned-value distributions can be reviewed against the class table in one place.

9. Open questions

1. `classGainAlt` (0 - 3.66) groups gains spanning 4 orders of scale (`AltVelKi` 0.00027 → `AltVelKd` 1.0). The shared raw ceiling keeps the FC clamp simple, but the tier-3 fallback slider is coarse for small-scale members — acceptable since real frames carry `[LIMITS]`, but confirm we want this grouping vs. separate one-off ceilings per alt gain.
2. `MadgwickKpMag` (scale 0.01) and `MadgwickKpAcc` (scale 1.0) are treated as one-offs — confirm.
3. Exact class ceiling numbers (section 4.1) need validation against all `.af` files during implementation.